

**LUANSHYA CONSTITUENCY
FISH FARMING
SUCCESS STORY**



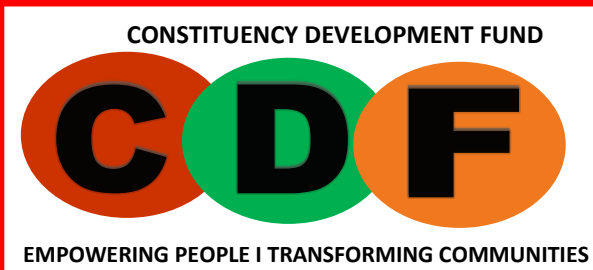
**KAMUCHANGA ROAD
PROJECT:
GAME CHANGER**



**VIEWS FROM THE
PARLIAMENTARIANS**



LUANSHYA & ROAN CDF TODAY



AUGUST 2024

Empowerments Time





STATEMENT BY: HIS WORSHIP THE MAYOR CLLR CHARLES MULENGA MAYOR OF LUANSHYA

With great honour and pleasure, I welcome you all to the first ever edition of the revised ROAN LU-ANSHYA CDF TODAY Monthly News Magazine.

The Constituency Development Fund (CDF) is Government's flagship development and service delivery programme with core focus of promoting the local authority's capacity to deliver social-economic development using the decentralization programme.

The Government has over the past three years been making frantic efforts to fine tune the policies guiding the implementation of CDF so that accountability and efficiency is enhanced amongst the local authority's capacity to manage CDF.

The revision of CDF guidelines, monitoring and evaluation regulation, including the provision of CDF monitoring vehicles to all the 156 constituencies in the country is a clear demonstration the Government is determined to use CDF Funds to stimulate economic growth using a citizen participatory projects implementation approach.

"Therefore, I am confident that the measures mentioned and many others which will be put in place in the near future will not only help to stimulate social-economic growth but also attain the quest by Government that the millions of kwacha being injected into the District through the annual release of the 30.6 million CDF to each constituency remain with the District to boost wealth creation among the local people."

The Government has continued to make efforts to transform local authority's into key players in the quest to facilitate for wealth creation amongst ordinary citizens which are now being encouraged to formalize their business through forming and registering community clubs, cooperatives and Small and Medium Enterprises which will also in term make it easy for them to access financing facilities such as grants and loans among others.

As Mayor, I am happy to note that the Government of President Hakainde Hichilema has introduce a dynamic approach to not only the implementation of CDF projects but also the Decentralisation Policy which also being made responsive to the people it is supposed to serve.

The continued provision in trainings in efficient and effective way to access tenders, basic business management and financial literacy to CDF beneficiaries ells in creating a favorable business environment for boosting individual SMEs and joint investment ventures among local based companies.

I have no doubt that with the various capacity building programmes being sponsored by the local authority will lead to a situation where the number of registered SMEs and business startup will be on an upswing.

As Mayor, my wish is that you will not only enjoy reading this publication, but also think of how in your small way as a patriotic resident of our garden town, you will help the local authority, your business, your neighbour or community of how to maximize the reaping from the benefits of the CDF, which has not only come to stay but also better our lives.

**CLLR CHARLES MULENGA
MAYOR OF LUANSHYA TOWN.**

STATEMENT BY: SOMBO KAWILILA KAELE (MRS) THE TOWN CLERK LUANSHYA MUNICIPAL COUNCIL



On behalf of the Management and Staff of Luanshya Municipal Council. I wish to extend to you our warmth which comes with the inaugural revised edition of the Roan & Luanshya "CDF Today" monthly publication.

The Local Authority wishes to provide you with as much information about the Constituency Development Fund (CDF) as possible.

We are equally hopeful that this publication will also supplement other existing platforms which the Council uses to interact with residents and stakeholders. The publication comes with some special features such as the Letters to the Editor, which will act as a public forum where residents will be allowed to write brief letters on various issues or concern or interest about the CDF in our two constituencies.

The CDF has now been transformed into one of the major Central Government's national development delivery vehicles.

This publication will be one of the information dissemination avenues for the Local authority but at the same time it will also be empowering the readers, who are residents of this town with a mechanism of providing checks and balances to the Luanshya Municipal Council as far as the implementation of the CDF is concerned.

Through our Public Relations Unit, who are tasked with the overall production and day to day management of this periodical, we hope to be informing, educate and entertain residents and stakeholders, while at the same time adhering to basic tenants of professional journalism of truth, objectivity, public interest, fair and balanced comment, which I have no doubt will act as the corner stone's of the editorial policy of publication.

The CDF, which has in the recent past been subjected to reviews as a way of fine tuning it to better meet needs an expectations of the

ordinary Zambians who need various forms of empowerment.

The CDF is our country's premier platform for promoting community based businesses revival and local development and has now been transformed into a truly game changer, which has brought about a chance for a fresh start for innovative Zambians who want to start businesses or provide various services.

The fund is creating limitless opportunities for Small and Medium Enterprises and individuals who want to think outside the box and are ready to explore new markets and capitalize on emerging business, service delivery and general best practice trends.

Our wish as people who have been entrusted with the noble cause of managing CDF projects on behalf of the Central Government is that as many deserving Luanshya residents as possible will from now on-wards start forming cooperatives, clubs, Small and Medium Industries (SMEs) and apply to have their community projects, grants, loans, boarding school bursaries, youth skills empowerment bursary or any other businesses which are being advertises on social media and the local radio stations.

Our clarion call to Luanshya residents is for them to seize this opportunity, use CDF to change your life for the better and build business partnerships and create pathways sustained social-economic development, which is focused on building the Luanshya we wants. The Luanshya we shall all be proud of. Using CDF doing so is no longer a farfetched dream.

Enjoying reading Roan & Luanshya CDF Today publication and be free to give us feedback by writing letters to the Editor.

SOMBO KAWILILA KAELE



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K3 MILLION MORTUARY, DESKS SUPPLY DEAL SEALED



By Gideon Thole

The Luanshya Municipal Council (LMC) has sealed a K 3 000,000-00 (three million Kwacha) deal with six local contractors for the construction of a mortuary and the supply and delivery of over 800 double seater desks for Luanshya Central Constituency based schools.

During a Signing ceremony held at the Luanshya Civic Centre, Town Clerk Sombo Kawilila signed various contracts, among them a contract worth K 1.7 million for the construction of Chenda-maunga mortuary in Roan Constituency.

Ms Kawilila also signed a K680, 000 worth contract for the supply and delivery 400 double setter desks. Other contracts were also signed for the supply of 400 desks.

Speaking during the signing ceremony , Ms Kawilila urged the contractors to ensure that the value for the CDF was positively impacting both the Government and the community by executing the contracts on time and creating employment for the youth and other members of their communities who also to deserve to benefit from the contracts directly and indirectly.

She explained that the management of the Council and other key stakeholders would be from time to time visit CDF projects sites because they are all committed to see to that that all projects signed under CDF comes to fruition without any failures.

She caution contractors to be professional and timeously report any challenges to their projects managers under the Council's Department of Engineering services to ensure that the same are managed and thus avoid any potential future loses of project failures.





CDF: 280 Get EGP Skills

By Gideon Thole

transparency among others.

The Luanshya Municipal Council has empowered a total of 280 Constituency Development Fund (CDF) sponsored contractors and suppliers with electronic procurement skills aimed at ensuring that local entrepreneurs' capacity to bid for tenders and win contractors is enhanced.

Luanshya Mayor Charles Mulenga says the Local Authority wants to see to it that local companies are assisted to comparatively do business as well as ensuring the local economy maximize its ability to benefit from lucrative CDF tenders and contracts by boosting entrepreneurs' capacity to compete on a level playing field.

Luanshya Municipal Council over the weekend organised a two-day Local Contractors and Suppliers Electronic Government Procurement (EGP) system Capacity Building Workshop.

Speaking during the EGP Capacity Building Workshop opening ceremony, the Luanshya Mayor said the Local Authority wants to see to it that local suppliers and contractors from both Roan and Luanshya Central constituencies access knowledge on how to individually use the EGP system.

Mayor Mulenga explained that the capacity-building program was aimed at achieving the following among others:

- Increased engagement of contractors and suppliers
- Clearly defining the requirements of public procurement
- Enhancing communication with contractors and suppliers through regular up-dates
- Promoting the use of digital technology and

The City Father commended the Council's management and the CDF committees for both Luanshya Central and Roan constituencies for facilitating for the hosting capacity building workshop, which will result into many local companies, cooperatives and enterprising apply for various CDF projects.

Zambia Public Procurement Authority (ZPPA) acting director of research and capacity building Terry Gunduza said electronic procurement is now law and its usage should be embraced by local companies in the same manner they embrace latest technology when dealing with mobile money or academic training technology.

Mr Gunduza said one of the major benefits of participating or adopting the e-procurement system is its ability to increase traceability and strengthening internal control that ease the detection of integrity breaches. Officiating during the Workshop's closing ceremony.

Luanshya Town Clerk Sombo Kawilila expressed optimism that local contractors and suppliers now have what it takes to effectively compete and win local or national tenders being floated by the ZPPA on-line.

“Now that local contractors and suppliers have been empowered with all the necessary knowledge on how to bid for various local and national tenders as Luanshya Municipal Council we hope to see a situation where blame game comes to an end.” Ms Kawilila said.

The Town Clerk further said that local contractors and suppliers are now expected to start monitoring the Electronic Government Procurement System and applying for various contracts and tenders on line in accordance with the provisions of the Public Procurement Act Number 8 of 2020.

LUANSHYA DC LAUDS TVTC ROLE IN CDF SKILLS TRAINING

By Susan M'sichili

Luanshya District Commissioner (DC) Oncemore Ngonomo says the Government is set to promote entrepreneurship and equal opportunities among all youths in the mining town and the country in general through skills training.

Mr Ngonomo, who was officiating as guest of honour during the Constituencies Development Fund (CDF) Skills Bursaries sponsored students Business Enterprises Mini Fair recently held at the Technical Vocation Teachers College (TVTC) in Luanshya, said the Government was committed to supporting youth success by providing the necessary resources for skills training and employment creation.

Mr Ngonomo commended TVTC management for coming up with skills training programs that open the doors for career opportunities, entrepreneurship apart from creating the chance to contribute to the growth of the local economy.

The CDF sponsored Skills Training Bursary and other self sponsored students participated in the Mini Business Fair which was held under theme, "Transforming Youth Skills for the Future", where the students exhibited their metal, fabrication, woodwork, bricklaying and plastering programs services and products among others.

Speaking earlier, Luanshya Mayor Charles Mulenga commended TVTC for making entrepreneurship training a compulsory course for all students at the institution.

Mayor Mulenga said learning entrepreneurship helps students develop their business acumen which enhances their potential,

vision and passion which are all needed to succeed in starting any kind of business.



LUANSHYA District Commissioner (DC) Oncemore Ngonomo

Luanshya Central CDF Chairperson Professor Sherry Coleman appealed to CDF Skills Bursaries sponsored students to work hard and show appreciation to the Government, which has given them a chance to transform themselves and their communities through the empowerment which they have received.

TVTC principal Harrison Phiri said his institution was committed to empower as many youths as possible with various crafts and entrepreneurship skills aimed at brightening their own future and transforming them into active players in the economic growth and development of the country.

Some students, who grouped themselves into entrepreneurship studies companies projects. The project based companies are from: Roan and Luanshya Central, Kanfinsa, Wusakile, and Kalulushi Mufulra and Chambeshi, Nkana, Chimwemwe.

Mr Ngonomo commended TVTC management for coming up with skills training programs that open the doors for career opportunities, entrepreneurship apart from creating the chance to contribute to the growth of the local economy.

FISH FARMING SUCCESS STORY



Luanshya Central MP Lusali Simbao

By Gideon Thole

Luanshya Central Member of Parliament (MP) Lusali Simbao says he is impressed with the tenacity and resiliency shown by Kapupulu Farm Block based Kuyuma Multi-Purpose Cooperative Society Fish Farming Project members, who he described as “shining example” of rare commitment to project implementation.

Mr Simbao said despite the adverse effects of the drought members of the cooperative remained committed to their projects goals and did everything possible within their means to see to it that they realized their goal to harvest fish for sell, and as a way of empowering themselves and their community.

The Luanshya Central parliamentarian officiated as Guest of Honour during the Kuyuma Multi-purpose Cooperative Society first-ever fish harvesting help in Kapupulu area.

Mr Simbao urged members the Kuyuma Cooperative Society to apply for additional funding under the 2025 CDF in order to grow their fish farming business now that they have gained experience in managing fish even under difficult circumstances.



Luanshya Central CDF Committee representative Austin Zimba said the position of the CDF Committee I was to see to it that cooperatives which have exhibited exemplary and effective project implementation are encouraged to apply for additional funding.

Kuyuma Multi-Purpose Cooperative Society chairperson Anthony Chimba said all the K 38,000 which his cooperative received after making a successful application of the CDF Grant was invested to fish farming business.

According Mr Chimba the fish farming project is transforming the lives of the members of a total of 62 families, whose breadwinners now have a source of income which will help improve their household's standards of living.

Mr Chimba said the fish farming business which his cooperative wants to transform into a sustainable all-seasons activity was expected to act as source of the much needed protein for members of his cooperative.

He added that the community in kapupulu, who will now be consuming more fish which would be readily available throughout the year.

CHIBUYE LEADS CDF SENSITISATION IN ROAN CONSTITUENCY

By Susan M'schili

Luanshya Council undertook a community sensitization programme in Roan Constituency.

The following places were covered during the sensitization programme, Mpatamatu Secondary School and Mpatamatu Market.

During the Sensitization programme, which was being led by Member of Parliament Joel Chibuye, who accompanied Council employees during the meetings which were attended by with scores of community members.

The sensitization programme bordered on the guidelines of CDF and have accessibility on the Forms for Loans, Grants, Boarding School bursary and skills bursary under Constituency Development Funded (CDF).

Hon. Chibuye remarked during the sensitization meeting that CDF is for every Zambian and the Community must ensure that they partake in CDF to support efforts entrenched towards the reduction of extreme poverty in the communities through engaging themselves to be empowered through Constituency Development Funded (CDF) in order to sustain their lives.

He also appealed to all the Ward Development Committee's (WDCs) not to engage themselves in any form of corruption, which is an offence under the laws of Zambia.

During the sensitization programme, the community members were very happy with the information disseminated from the facilitating team and received their forms for CDF.



Roan MP Joel Chibuye



BUNTUNGWA BRIDGE CONSTRUCTION IN TOP GEAR

By Staff Writer

Luanshya Mayor Charles Mulenga says he is impressed with the manner in which Luanshya Central Constituency Development Fund (CDF) financed construction works of Buntungwa Bridge on the outskirts of Mikonfwa area is going on.

Buntungwa Bridge, which connects Zambezi, Buntungwa and Kankwiba area has over the past years had a history of being washed away and making the area impassable has now been replaced with a two metres plus high permanent structure, which will stand the taste of time.

The Mayor, who visited the bridge construction site during the weekend in the company of Deputy Mayor Austin Zimba and Zambezi Ward Councillor Emmanuel Chewe, expressed satisfaction with the manner in which construction works are going on.

He said the Local Authority was happy that Buntungwa Bridge which plays a crucial role in the promotion of the informal sector growth in the three wards which it links.

Mayor Mulenga observed that the activities of the farming community and market traders which had slowed down during the period of the construction works would now be revived as the construction works would be completed soon.

The City Father expressed gratitude to the residents of Zambezi, Buntungwa and Kankwiba areas whose day-to-day activities were being inconvenienced by the construction works for being patient and allowing the contractor to construct the bridge in accordance with the specifications of the contract.

The Mayor also thanked the residents of Butungwa, Kankwiba and Zambezi for their wise decision to use

CDF to construct a permanent bridge across Buntungwa stream, which used to be impassable during the rainy season.

Zambezi Ward area Councilor Emmanuel Chewe observed that the construction of the bridge using CDF was evidence that the Local Authority and the Government were committed to promoting development.

Councillor Chewe said the construction of the and allowing resident of wards to have access to national resources and also deciding the best way they wish to Benefit From CDF was making the Decentralization Policy implementation in Luanshya District a reality.

One of the locals who has been using Buntungwa Bridge for more than four decades now, Mary Chanda, thanked Luanshya Municipal Council and the Government for agreeing to finance the construction of a bridge that will stand the taste to time.

Ms Chanda said the farming communities and the traders at Kambilimbilo Market who have had their businesses affected over the years whenever the bridge was damaged or over powered by the pressure from heavy water flow.

She explained that construction of a new bridge will now have their problems put to rest because the structure will stand the taste of time.

Some other individuals who are engaged in commercial and subsistence farming related activities in Kankwiba and Kafubu Block areas talked to by this author, said the construction of a permanent bridge at the Buntungwa stream will change their social and economic wellbeing.

Nzanji Construction Company was awarded the contract to construct the CDF financed Buntungwa bridge.



Luanshya Mayor Charles Mulenga



CDF VANDALISM: PUBLIC ENEMY NO. 1

By Staff Writer

Luanshya Municipal Council is appealing to residents of the mining town to desist from engaging in acts of vandalism involving Constituency Development Fund (CDF) financed public facilities.

The Council has observed that there is a drastic increase in the reported cases of vandalism involving newly installed electrical, water reticulation and sanitation facilities in markets and other public facilities, which it manages.

These retrogressive acts of vandalism are negatively affecting the Council's execution of its service delivery mandate to residents apart from being a threat to public health and safety.

The Council has in the past one month recorded thefts of overhead power cables on two separate occasions at Morning Market, and another similar power cable is reported to have been stolen at D Market in Mikonfwa township.

The increase in thefts of overhead cables has led to situations where markets are plunged into darkness from time to time.

The affected facilities are sometimes temporarily shut down like in the case for the CDF financed new ablution facility at Main Market as the stolen items, which includes water pipes, and ventilation cups are being replaced.

The replacement of vandalised installations is a drain on Council resources as it is being done at the expense of service delivery to residents of Luanshya.

The acts of vandalism have been reported to the police while the Council's Engineering Services Department has started assessing the costs as part of the processes aimed at preparing for the procurement of the vandalized installations.

Luanshya Municipal Council is hopeful that the law enforcement agencies will not relent in their quest to being to book perpetrators of these acts of vandalism who deserve to face the full wrath of the law.



CDF financed new ablution block at Main Market

K4.8 MILLION CDF COMMUNITY PROJECTS LAUNCHED

By Staff Writer

Seven Constituency Development Fund (CDF) financed community projects worth K 4, 800,000-00 have been launched in Luanshya's Roan Constituency.

The projects, which were recently launched during a ceremony held at Roan Police Station, officiated by Copperbelt Province Minister Elisha Matambo are: The replacement of windows at Mpatamatu Police Station costing K 20, 000-00, Construction of 1 by 3 - Classroom Block at Mwaiseni Primary School at a cost of K821, 222- 86. Construction of an Ablution Block at Section 25 Market at a cost of K506, 795-96.

The other CDF financed community projects, which have been completed and also being are: The Construction of a Bridge in Kansengu ward in Mpatamatu area at a cost of K937, 333-54. The rehabilitation roan police station where K 606, 956- 20 has been spent.

Additional projects are the Construction of a Boundary Wall at Nkulumashiba Secondary School whose cost was K702, 342 -34 and the Completion of a School Hall at Twashuka secondary school at a cost of K702, 660-00.

Speaking during the official 2024 CDF Projects launch in Roan Constituency, the Copperbelt Minister urged the people to brace for more massive CDF projects, which are currently being executed in their constituency.



Copperbelt Province Minister Elisha Matambo



Minister Elisha Matambo cutting the ribbon

What we are witnessing here is a sign of better things coming because of prudent management of the country's resources by President Hakainde Hichilema, he said.

Minister Matambo said Zambia's future was bright. He said the Government has a mandate to deliver development through action and not lip service.

Roan Member of Parliament (MP) Joel Chibuye said that the effective execution of the Constituency Development Fund (CDF) in his constituency has lifted people's standards of living. He said public infrastructure such as hospitals and schools most of which were constructed during the colonial era, before Zambia became independent were now being refurbished, adding that individuals and local businesses were being empowered with loans and grants.

The Roan MP thanked President Hakainde Hichilema for being consistent in the execution of CDF projects. He said the people of Roan Constituency have pledged to continue supporting President Hichilema and his Government because of the unprecedented development, which the area is experiencing.

Luanshya Mayor Charles Mulenga said the Government has given Roan constituency, a colossal sum of money K30.6 million on a silver Platter. He called on the residents of Roan to ensure that their areas change for the better in terms of development.

"Let me remind each one of us gathered here that it's up to us as beneficiaries to ensure that we use CDF prudently because our lives should no longer be the same, our communities should no longer be the same now that CDF is readily available for us all. He added: "In short, our mode of working and our interactions should change for the better." The projects, which have been launched, are aimed at helping in the uplifting of Roan Constituency residents standards of living, apart from improving their social and economic wellbeing as more old public infrastructure such as police stations, schools and water reticulation systems among others, are now being replaced through various CDF financed community projects costing millions of Kwacha.



Some Roan Constituency WDC Workshop participants



CDF Officer Aquilla Mushitu making a presentation

WDC LEADERS: BACK TO SCHOOL

By Susan M'sichili

The Luanshya Municipal Council has embarked on an ambitious programme aimed at orientating newly elected members of the Ward Development Committee (WDC) on how to perform their role and effectively serve the community.

The orientation programme started with Roan Constituency and later extended to Luanshya

Constituency.

The training is aimed at preparing and equipping the WDCs as they take up their responsibilities for the next two and a half years. The formulation of WDCs country wide is part of Government's decentralization efforts to empower grassroots stakeholders to have a deciding role in the District's development through the WDCs, which are the lowest sub-district structures in the local government



Some Workshop participants

PHOTO FOCUS



Copperbelt Province Minister Elisha Matambo and Roan MP Joel Chibuye during CDF Community Empowerment Launch in Roan Constituency



Newly rehabilitated ablution block at Mipundu Primary school



Luanshya Central MP Lusale Simbao during the handover of ablution block at Mipundu Primary School



Luanshya DC Oncemore Ngonomo inspecting Newly rehabilitated ablution block at Mipundu Primary school



Luanshya Town Clerk Sombo Kaela (centre) and participants of CDF Procurement Workshop at a Civic Centre recently.

CDF VIEWS FROM THE PARLIAMENTARIANS



**Turning a page:
Luanshya Central MP
Lusale Simbao Urges
residents of his
constituency to take up
an active role in
shaping their own
development agenda.**

My office is a centre for information and those that Need clarification on many developmental programmes taking place in the constituency are very free to come through. In my absence, there will be the Professional Assistant and the Administrative assistant are available to attend to such important concerns.

I would like to state that currently the constituency as a way of seeking solutions to community problems and one such solution is the prudent use of the Constituency Development Fund (CDF). This one has made it possible that the members of the community can make their own agenda to bring development in the community they live. This is the only way government can respond to the immediate needs of the community.

As you may be away, the first aspect that has been dealt with is to ensure that we localise the local authority through the Ward Development Committees who understand the ward better because they are part of the ward. The Wards Development Committee is the first in the development line. Any application that has to come through the Constituency Development Fund Committee needs the endorsement of the community leadership.

I must hasten to state that we have old Schools being repaired and new schools are being constructed at the same time. Additionally, desks for all school are being acquired in order to make sure that by 31 December 2023 No pupil will be sitting on the floor. As a matter of urgency, we have also resolved that each school currently under construction will need water borne toilet. It is the commitment to make life better for our people.

In my opinion, the constituency only need to unite and put our heard together as stakeholders and make the Constituency Development Fund work for us. Through the Local Authority and the District Commissioners office, we have endeavoured as government to come up with interventions through the Integrated Development Plan. The IDP informs the eighth Development plan which is in line of achieving the vision 2030. I would like to urge our technocrats to reveal the IDP to the members of the public in order for the district to move as a united front in the face of any form of retrogression.

When our people are aware of the master plan for the district, they will join in to come up with projects that respond to the plan. In so doing Constituency Development Funds will be properly utilised for the good course.

In Conclusion, I would like to put it on record that I am so happy with a number of work that we have done as Luanshya Constituency. I am also happy that a number of Businessmen and women have been able to present their bankable proposals, which have received support without looking at colour, creed or tribe. I am looking forward to more people coming out to participate in the development agenda through their projects as Clubs, Cooperatives or Companies.

Forward with Development



**Roan MP Joel Chibuye
has some good news
for CDF recipients.**

As an elected representative of the people of Roan Constituency, I have no doubt that prudent use and management of Constituency Development Funds (CDF) is going to improve the wellbeing of the people residing within the confines our area's marked boundaries.

If we can all come together and present our ideas, brain storm and see what we can come up with in terms of projects, which can meet the common interest of the majority of our people.

It seems like some people still do not believe that CDF is real and that it the game changer.

It is responsible for the on-going unprecedented development being experiences across various sectors of the economy not only here in Luanshya but in all the 156 constituencies.

As residents of Roan Constituency, we have a duty and moral obligation to come up with to identity and support bankable developmental projects, which should be financed using CDF. IT is important that we come up with companies, which should be registered at the Patents and Company Registration Agency (PACRA), team up and form cooperatives and clubs, which are some of the ways in which we can access CDF according to the provisions of the CDF guidelines.

I am aware that there are those who are part of the group, which is now known as local contractors, who applied to participate in the bidding for contracts and did not make it, my message is hard luck.

We have a situation where out of the K30.6 million annual CDF allocation for each constituency K16 millions goes to projects implementation.

One of the mayor activities being undertaken using CDF is to improve the learning environment and addressing the welfare of the learners. That is why a significant amount of CDF is now being used to procure desks for all Government owned primary and secondary schools. In fact, the desk issue is a Presidential directive to all constituencies throughout the country.

On the same issue of desks, I feel we have been dragging out feet- we are too slow. I wish to urge all stakeholders to deal with this matter with the seriousness it deserves. We need to fulfill and actualize the presidential directive.

If we work as a team we have close to K7 million to spend on the procurement of double sitter school desks. The CDF Committee resolved not give one supplier of desks; we decided to break the procurement into eleven lots as a way of accommodating, as may local suppliers as possible.

As CDF beneficiaries, we should take advantage of the free financial literacy, and basic entrepreneurship training, which Luanshya Council provides which we should grasp and seriously consider adopting a form of Culture Remodeling process.

Good-bye for now.

Yours truly – your loyal Servant

Joel Chibuye MP.